



Improving the Moment

A way to remember these skills is the word **IMPROVE**.

With Imagery:

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| ☐ Imagine very relaxing scenes. | ☐ Imagine hurtful emotions draining out of you like water out of a pipe. |
| ☐ Imagine a secret room within yourself. Furnish it the way you like. Close and lock the door on anything that can hurt you. | ☐ Remember a happy time and imagine yourself in it again; play out the time in your mind again. |
| ☐ Imagine everything going well. | ☐ Other: _____ |
| ☐ Make up a calming fantasy world. | |

With Meaning:

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| ☐ Find purpose or meaning in a painful situation. | ☐ Remember, listen to, or read about spiritual values. |
| ☐ Focus on whatever positive aspects of a painful situation you can find. | ☐ Other: _____ |
| ☐ Repeat these positive aspects in your mind. | |

With Prayer:

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| ☐ Open your heart to a supreme being, God, or your own Wise Mind. | ☐ Turn things over to God or a higher being. |
| ☐ Ask for strength to bear the pain. | ☐ Other: _____ |

With Relaxing actions:

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| ☐ Take a hot bath or sit in a hot tub. | ☐ Breathe deeply. |
| ☐ Drink hot milk. | ☐ Change your facial expression. |
| ☐ Massage your neck and scalp. | ☐ Other: _____ |
| ☐ Practice yoga or other stretching. | |

With One thing in the moment:

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| ☐ Focus your entire attention on just what you are doing. | ☐ Focus your entire attention on the physical |
| ☐ Keep yourself in the moment. | ☐ Listen to a sensory awareness recording (or use Distress Tolerance Handout 9a) |
| ☐ Put your mind in the present. | ☐ Other: _____ |

With a brief Vacation:

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| ☐ Give yourself a brief vacation. | ☐ Take a blanket to the park and sit on it for a whole afternoon. |
| ☐ Get in bed; pull the covers up over your head. | ☐ Take a 1-hour breather from hard work. |
| ☐ Go to the beach or the woods for the day. | ☐ Take a brief vacation from responsibility. |
| ☐ Get a magazine and read it with chocolates. | ☐ Other: _____ |
| ☐ Turn off your phone for a day. | |

With self-Encouragement and rethinking the situation:

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| ☐ Cheerlead yourself: “You go, girl!” “You da man!” | ☐ “This too shall pass.” |
| ☐ “I will make it out of this.” | ☐ “I will be OK.” |
| ☐ “I’m doing the best I can.” | ☐ “It won’t last forever.” |
| ☐ Repeat over and over: “I can stand it.” | ☐ Other: _____ |

List (and then practice) rethoughts that are particularly important in your crisis situations (e.g., “The fact that he did not pick me up doesn’t mean he doesn’t love me”):

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| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
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